Final Assignment: Research Proposal

Visual Communication in Campus Media: Assessing the Quality of ULAB TV's Graphic Content and Its PR Impact

Submitted by

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Visual Communication in Campus Media: Assessing the Quality of ULAB TV's Graphic Content and Its PR Impact

Chapter 1

About the Organisation

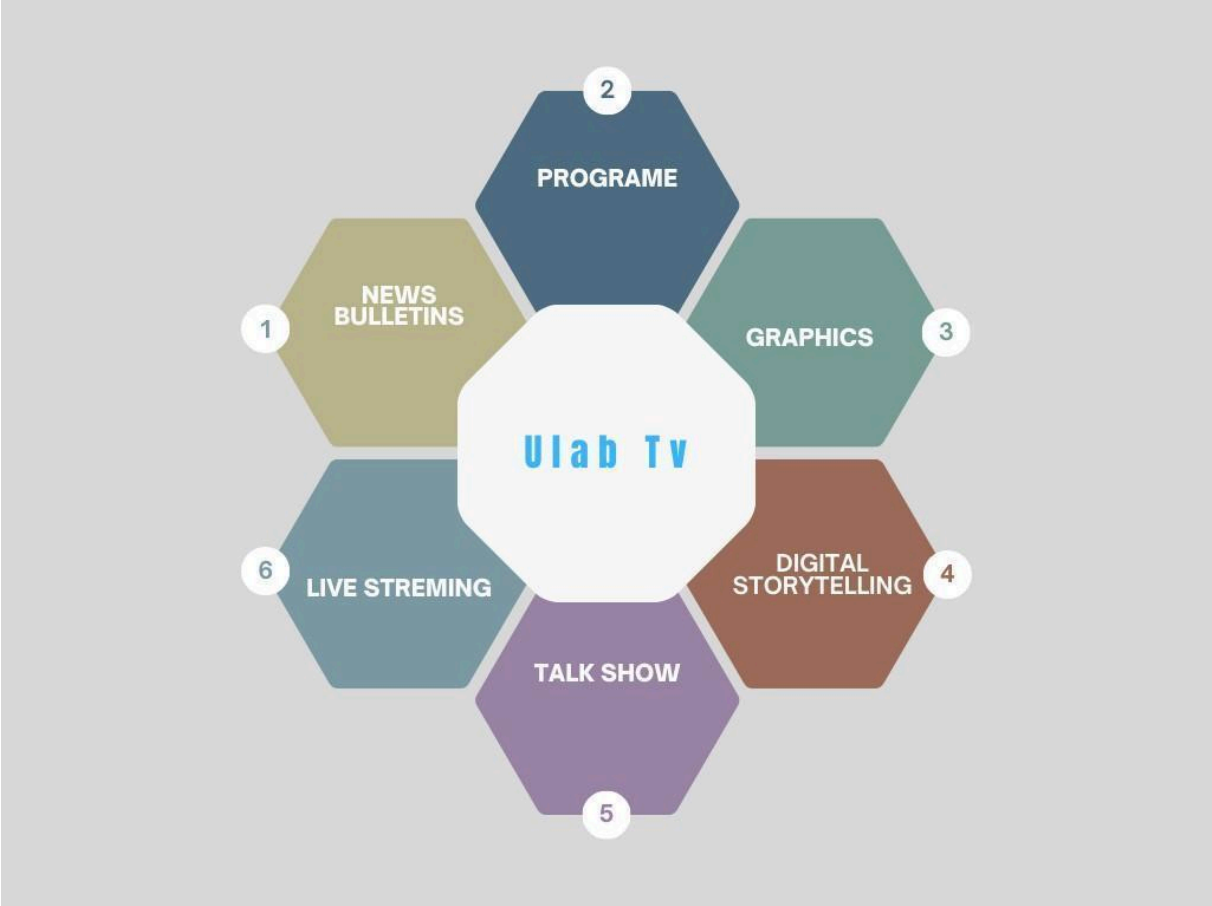
ULAB TV, a student-led media platform under the Department of Media Studies and Journalism (MSJ) at the University of Liberal Arts Bangladesh (ULAB), provides practical training opportunities for aspiring journalists through its apprenticeship program. The platform aims to enhance students' technical skills, improve content production quality, and prepare them for the competitive media industry. It was launched on 27th June 2013. This television station is run by its members, who are the current students of ULAB. It provides them with the opportunity to learn by doing, and thus it facilitates peer teaching and active learning, which is the main essence of journalism education. ULAB TV conducts various practical activities through its apprenticeship program**,** including news scriptwriting, camera operation, video editing, graphic design, program production, digital storytelling, mobile journalism, news casting, program anchoring, and live reporting to enhance students' hands-on media skills.

Organisation Mission & Vision

ULAB TV's mission is "to produce multi-skilled media professionals ready for the dynamic media landscape through active, project-based training.

Its vision emphasises nurturing *"decolonised minds through media education and innovation"*

Content Design:



Problem statement

Visual communication is one of the most important tools in shaping how people see an organisation in today's world. Has many types of content, but its graphic design, such as posters and visuals, has some interesting feedback on its social media. Some people call it weak, some people call it not a professional standard. Another reason can be that students around the world are allowed to use many apps, but you have to be only allowed to use software. So this rule limits creativity, makes work less productive and may hamper audience attention. Graphics content can also affect the perception of public relations. That's why we want to see if the visual communication as graphic content has anything to do with the influence of audience perception about Ulab TV.

Research Objectives

- To assess the quality of ULAB TV's graphic content.
- To examine audience perceptions regarding ULAB TV's graphic materials.

- To analyse the influence of ULAB TV's graphic content on its public relations strategies and overall brand image.

Research Questions

1. What is the quality of ULAB TV's graphic content?
2. How do audiences perceive ULAB TV's graphics compared to other apprenticeship-based media platforms?
3. In what ways does ULAB TV's graphic content impact its public relations and audience engagement?

Research scopes

Through this study, an assessment is provided that provides a comprehensive evaluation of the quality of graphic content produced by ULAB TV, focusing on both social media platform visuals and promotional graphics. It will explore how effectively these graphics communicate the intended message, maintain brand consistency, and engage the target audience. Last of all, the study seeks to understand the audience's perceptions of ULAB TV's visual communication strategies and analyse how these graphics influence the organisation's public relations attempt, overall credibility, and brand image.

Limitations

This research focuses fully on graphic content, which means it may not focus on capturing the potential influence of other types of content, such as video production, news bulletins, or digital storytelling, on public relations. The findings of reflect the role and productivity of ULAB TV's visual communication strategies rather than the overall impact of its plan of action. On the other hand, the study is based on a limited audience sample size, which may restrict the applicability of the results. These limitations should be carefully considered when analyzing the outcomes and broader conclusions about the effectiveness of ULAB TV's content and its role in shaping audience perceptions.

Chapter 2

Literature Review

Visual Storytelling in PR Campaigns

Visual storytelling has become an important element in public relations that enhances audience engagement, message feedback, and campaign are impact (Jenkins, 2024). Graphics such as infographics, social media visuals, and videos allow huge creative narratives, increasing across digital platforms. Jenkins emphasises that visuals not only attract attention but also support brand identity and emotion, which are effective for PR communication. Empirical studies and theoretical frameworks support these claims.This literature reflects that

broad media, incorporating both visual and textual elements, improve understanding and perception. Research also points out that aesthetic design elements, including colour, layout, and imagery, significantly influence audience response and reaction, credibility, and engagement in PR and marketing contexts (Azimi et al., 2012; Srivastava et al., 2017; Karduni et al., 2021).

Overall, the literature shows that strategically designed visual content, integrated with storytelling techniques, is a key driver of PR effectiveness. Industry insights like Jenkins' highlight practical application, while academic research confirms the cognitive and behavioural impact of visuals in shaping audience perception.

Social Television and Audience Engagement

Social Television reflects an elementary transformation in the relationship between traditional television and audiences, driven by technological advances such as mobile devices, streaming platforms, and social media integration (Arrojo, 2015). These technologies are not in that real-time interaction, allowing viewers to comment, share, and participate actively, going beyond the consumption model of conventional TV.

Arrojo (2015) identifies that this employment analysis both audience expectations and content design, requiring television producers to consider many innovative features and social connectivity. Social TV encourages viewing experiences, where the audiences not only consume content but also influences discussions and interpretations through social media platforms.

The press collides with theoretical perspectives on media convergence that Geerts (2011) categorises as Social TV based on its social functions, such as content selection, communication, community building, and status updates, highlighting its multifaceted nature in engaging audiences. Similarly, Harboe (2009) notes that Social TV engagement by broadcast content with interactive social experiences, emphasising emotional point social dimensions of audience participation.

Overall, Social TV represents a new communicative paradigm in which technology, interactivity, and social behaviour converge to create more immersive, participatory, and socially connected television experiences. This evolution has implications for broadcasters, marketers, and media researchers who seek to understand audience behaviour and design content strategies that leverage engagement and connectivity (Arrojo, 2015; Geerts, 2011; Harboe, 2009).

Graphic Design Perception & Its Relevance to Campus Media

Research on media design consistently highlights its role in shaping how audiences perceive, interpret, and interact with content. Mohamed (2025) makes that design elements such as visual hierarchy, colour schemes, typography, and layout directly influence clarity and message retention. Well-structured designs reduce cognitive overload by guiding viewer attention toward key information, enhancing understanding and engagement.

Emotional engagement is another critical factor. Visual cues like colours and imagery can emotions that shape how audiences respond to content, supporting earlier work by Norman (2004), who links aesthetic experiences to user satisfaction and trust. mainly, cognitive load theory (Sweller, 1988) Mohamed's claims that intuitive design improves focus, enabling users to concentrate on solving problems rather than navigating complex interfaces.

Interactive features and feedback mechanisms involvement by reinforcing comprehension and ensuring active learning (Lidwell et al., 2010). Similarly, visual metaphors through diagrams and infographics simplify abstract concepts into digestible formats, supporting educational and problem-solving contexts. Finally, consistent and professional design aesthetics enhance credibility and visibility, critical in today's saturated media environment (Mohamed, 2025).

Design as a Cognitive and Emotional Tool

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Emotional engagement is another critical part of visual content, like colors and imagery can elicit emotions that shape how audiences respond to content, supporting earlier work by Norman (2004), who links aesthetic experiences to user satisfaction and trust. Mainly cognitive load theory (Sweller, 1988) underpins Mohamed's claim that intuitive are design improves focus, enabling users to concentrate on solving problems rather than navigating complex interfaces.

Interactive features and feedback mechanisms further deepen user involvement by reinforcing comprehension and ensuring active learning (Lidwell et al., 2010). Similarly, visual metaphors through diagrams and infographics are simplify abstract concepts into consistent and professional design aesthetics and credibility and visibility, critical in today's saturated media environment (Mohamed, 2025).

Chapter 3

Research Approach

The population of this research is the underrated students, master students, alumni, and faculty who are the audience of ULAB TV. To collect our data, we chose a specific population that is convenient and accessible for us due to our direct access to the groups and personal connections among students and faculty. Within this demography, it became easy

and convenient for us to gather this information effectively. Since students are also tech savvy also teachers are familiar with digital tools. So this demographic quality also helped us to conduct our survey successfully in a very short time. In line with **Grunig and Hunt's Excellence Theory** and the **Two-Way Symmetrical Communication Model**, this approach ensures we understand how ULAB TV interacts with its audience and how visuals help establish mutual understanding and trust between the organization and its stakeholders.

Data Analysis

The collected survey data will be analyzed using descriptive statistics to identify overall patterns and perceptions. Responses will be categorized based on demographics such as undergraduate students, master's students, alumni, and faculty. Audience ratings on graphics quality, design, creativity, and colour usage will be evaluated to measure satisfaction levels. The analysis will also focus on how visuals influence engagement, brand perception, and ULAB TV's overall reputation, while summarizing key feedback, tool limitations, and suggestions for improvement.

Methodology

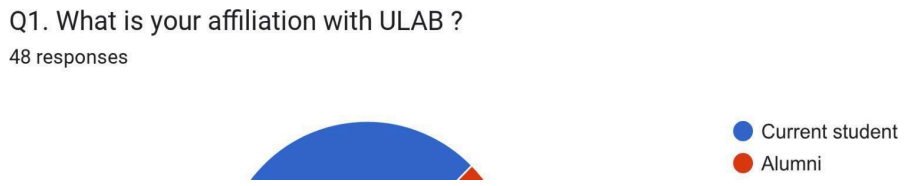
This study uses a quantitative research approach to assess the perception of the audience of graphics content. Collecting numerical data through a survey, this study measures how they evaluate the quality and effectiveness of these visuals. In this context, the Excellence Theory guides us to evaluate how ULAB TV's communication through visuals builds positive relationships, while the Situational Crisis Communication Theory (SCCT) helps us understand how audience perceptions shift when content quality does not meet expectations and how ULAB TV can address those concerns effectively. This approach allows a systematic analysis of audience perception on how graphic content influences their PR.

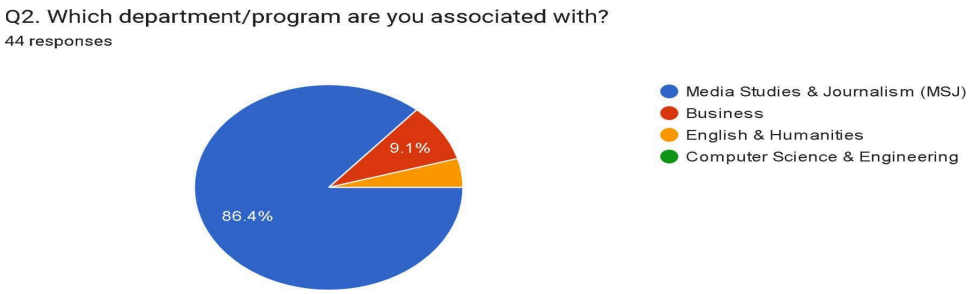
Sampling

This study uses convenience sampling, as participants including undergraduate students, master's students, alumni, and faculty were chosen based on easy accessibility through personal connections and ULAB networks. Participation was voluntary, allowing us to collect data quickly and effectively. This approach aligns with Excellence Theory and the Two-Way Symmetrical Communication Model, ensuring diverse audience perceptions are considered for analyzing ULAB TV's visual content and PR strategies.

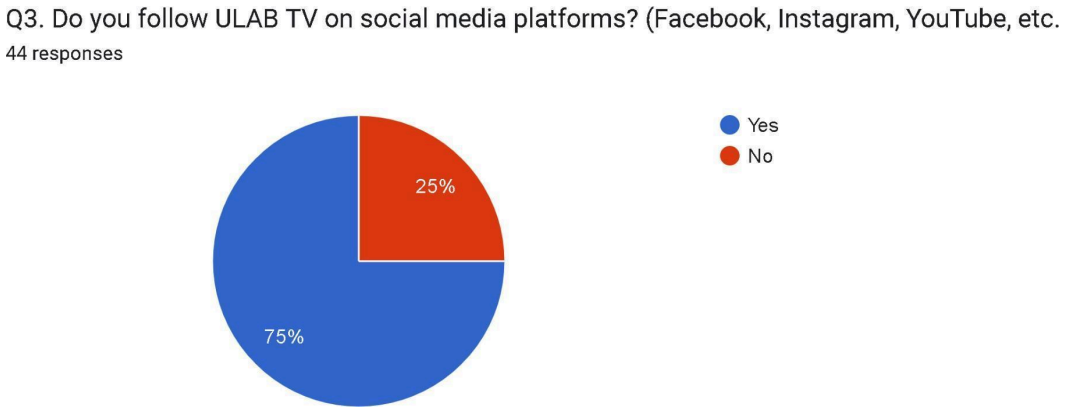
<u>Survey analysis</u>

The survey aimed to assess the quality of ULAB TV's graphic content and its PR impact. Although 20 responses were expected, 44 participants took part, offering wider insights. The questions explored visual appeal, brand identity, design style, engagement, and PR value. Overall, the feedback reflected indifference from some respondents but also strong calls for modern, creative, and consistent improvements in ULAB TV's visual communication





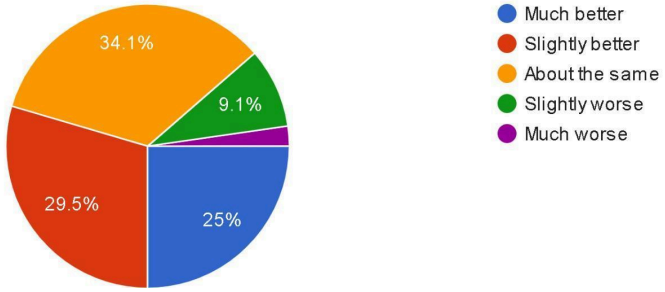
Many respondents felt ULAB TV's graphics are somewhat appealing but lack modernity and consistency. About 20% found the designs outdated, 15% said they lacked creativity and color use, while 34% gave no opinion, showing notable indifference.



Many respondents point out that ULAB TV's graphics are somewhat appealing but lack modernity, consistency, and creativity.. A notable 34% of respondents gave no clear opinion, reflecting a level of indifference toward visual content. The issue of brand identity also emerged strongly, with many participants noting that the graphics often appear fail to reflect ULAB TV's unique characteristics. This inconsistency was seen as a weakness that reduces both recognition and PR impact.

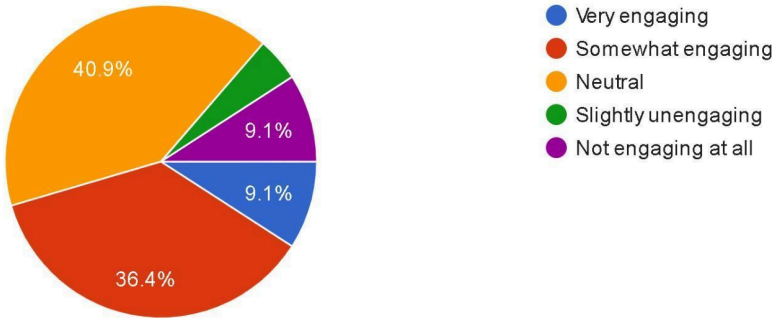
Q4. Compared to other campus or apprenticeship-based media platforms, ULAB TV's graphic quality is:

44 responses



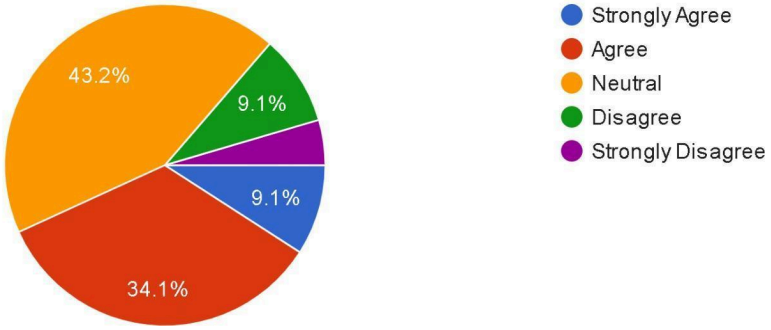
Q5. How engaging do you find ULAB TV's graphics on social media?

44 responses



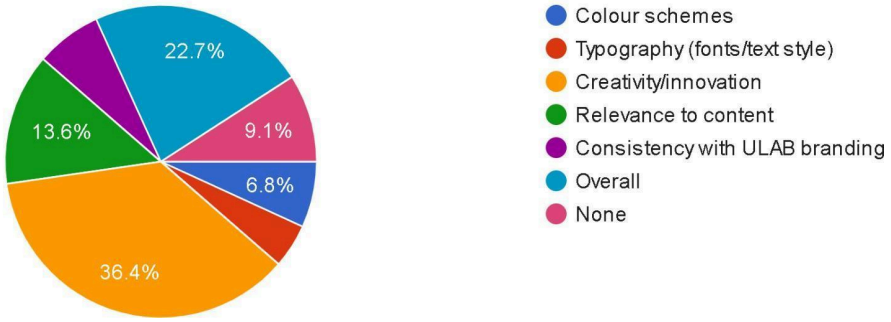
Q6. Do you find ULAB TV's graphic designs creative and visually appealing?

44 responses



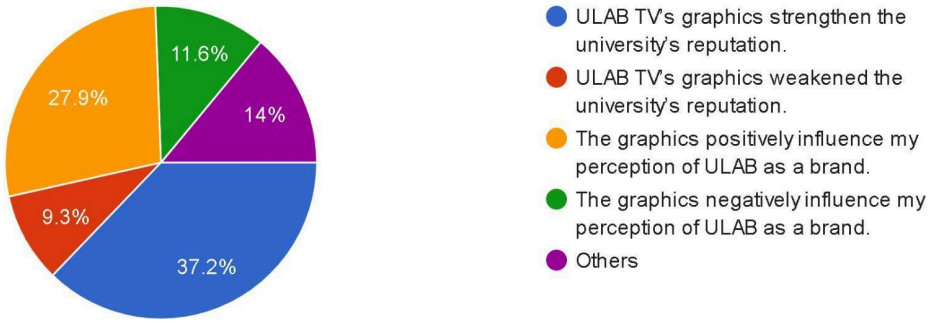
Q7. Which area of ULAB TV's graphics do you think needs the most improvement?

44 responses



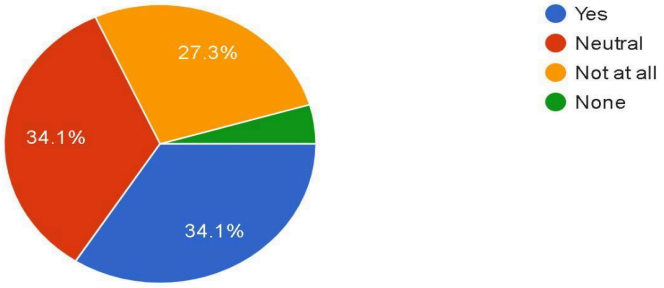
Q8. Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements:

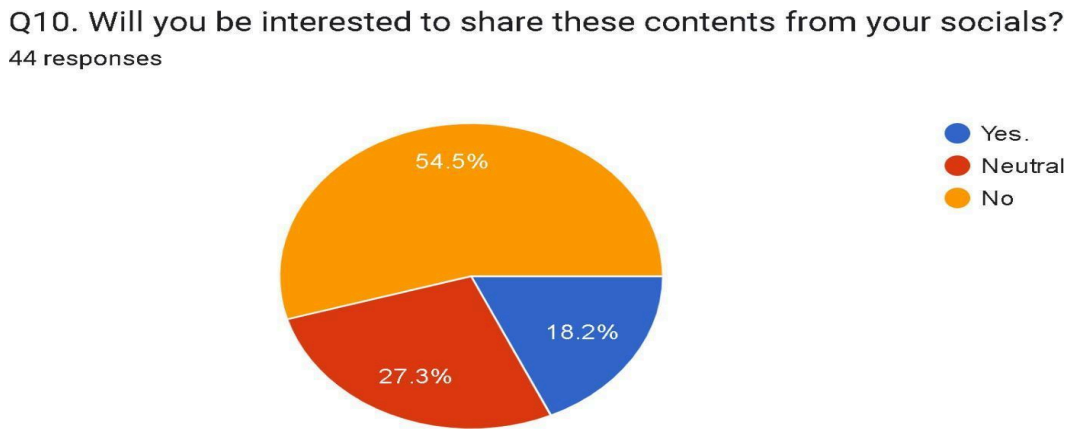
43 responses



Q9. Do you think ULAB TV's current graphic strategies align with modern PR and visual communication trends?

44 responses





Several respondents gave advice on a minimalist and modern approach with cleaner layouts, stronger typography, and better color combinations. Others emphasized that the content often fails to fully capture or sustain engagement, partly due to weak storytelling and partly due to a lack of awareness among students about the role of graphic design in communication. While some believed that improvements in aesthetics and creativity could enhance the PR value of ULAB TV.

Overall Result

The overall findings of the survey indicate that ULAB TV's graphic content requires significant improvement to enhance both its visual content and PR perspective. While a group of respondents claimed indifference, the majority expressed concerns about outdated designs, lack of creativity, and a weak audience. Many respondents describe the need for modern, minimalist, and creative design, with better use of colors, typography, and storytelling. Importantly, a considerable number suggested that small adjustments would not be enough and recommended a complete redesign of the graphic strategy. The responses also revealed a gap in awareness among students about the importance of graphic design, suggesting that, alongside technical improvements, ULAB TV should also work to build greater appreciation for visual communication.

Ethical Considerations

- Participants were informed about the survey's purpose, and their responses were given voluntarily.

- Personal information and identities of respondents were kept private to ensure trust and protection.

- Survey questions were designed without bias, and all opinions—positive negative—were valued equally.

- Every response was acknowledged respectfully without judgment or exclusion.

- Data was presented honestly, without manipulation, ensuring transparency and credibility in the research.

Recommendations

1. Develop a consistent brand identity that reflects ULAB TV's uniqueness and strengthens its recognition.

2. Adopt modern and minimalist design approaches with clean layouts and professional typography. Use Photoshop and other software like Canva, freepic, and shutterstoc.

3. Enhance creativity and storytelling by combining strong copywriting with visually engaging graphics.

4. Improve color selection and aesthetics to create trending content.

5. Raise awareness among students about the role of graphic design in effective communication and PR.

6. Implement a comprehensive redesign strategy rather than relying on minor adjustments.

Timeline

The Questionnaire of the online survey has been attached below:

Title: Exploring Visual Communication Strategies By Evaluating Ulab TV's Graphic Content And Its Influence On Audience Perception.

We are conducting an academic research project titled "Exploring Visual Communication Strategies by Evaluating ULAB TV's Graphic Content and Its Influence on Audience Perception." The purpose of this study is to assess the quality of ULAB TV's graphic content, understand how audiences perceive it, and analyze its impact on ULAB TV's public relations and overall brand image.

Q1. What is your affiliation with ULAB?

☐ Current student

☐ Alumni

☐ Faculty/Staff ☐

Other

Q2. Which department/program are you associated with?

☐ Media Studies & Journalism (MSJ)

☐ Business

☐ English & Humanities

☐ Computer Science & Engineering

☐ Other:

Q3. Do you follow ULAB TV on social media platforms? ***(Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, etc.)***

☐ Yes

☐ NO

Q4. Compared to other campus or apprenticeship-based media platforms, ULAB TV's graphic quality is:

☐ Much better ☐

Slightly better

☐ About the same

☐ Slightly worse ☐

Much worse

Q5. How engaging do you find ULAB TV's graphics on social media?

Very engaging

☐ Somewhat engaging

☐ Neutral

☐ Slightly unengaging

☐ Not engaging at all

Q6. Do you find ULAB TV's graphic designs creative and visually appealing?

☐ Strongly Agree

☐ Agree

☐ Neutral ☐

Disagree

☐ Strongly Disagree

Q7. Which area of ULAB TV's graphics do you think needs the most improvement?

☐ Colour schemes

☐ Typography (fonts/text style)

☐ Creativity/innovation

☐ Relevance to content

☐ Consistency with ULAB branding

☐ Overall

☐ None

☐ Other:

Q8. Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements:

☐ ULAB TV's graphics strengthen the university's reputation. ☐ ULAB TV's graphics weakened the university's reputation.

☐ The graphics positively influence my perception of ULAB as a brand. ☐ The graphics negatively influence my perception of ULAB as a brand. ☐ Other:

Q9. Do you think ULAB TV's current graphic strategies align with modern PR and visual communication trends?

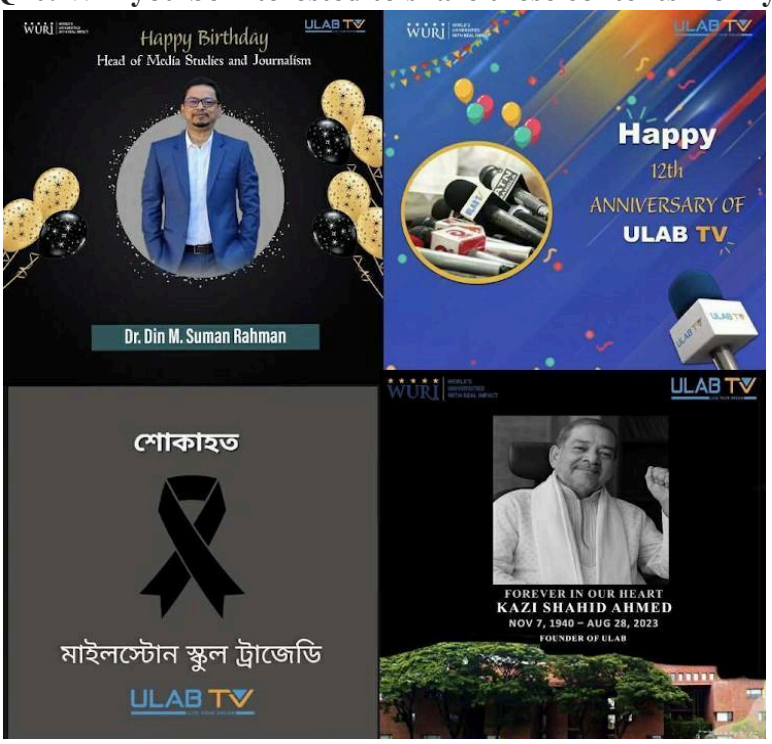
☐ Yes

☐ Neutral ☐

Not at all ☐

None

Q10. Will you be interested to share these contents from your socials?



☐ Yes.

☐ Neutral ☐

No

Q11. In today's media industry, do you feel limited by ULAB TV's rule of using only Adobe software for graphics and content creation?

☐ Yes ☐

No

☐ Other:

Q12. Do you have any suggestions for improving ULAB TV's graphic content?

☐ Ans:

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